THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

CLASS VIII — SOCIAL SCIENCE · PRACTICE QUESTION PAPER

Annual / Full-Syllabus Examination (Part 1 + Part 2) · Session 2026–27 · Set 03

Class: 8	Subject: Social Science	Set 03	Time Allowed: 2 Hours 30 Minutes	Max. Marks: 60

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper is divided into six sections – A, B, C, D, E and F.
3. Section A contains Question No. 1 with 15 sub-parts, all Multiple Choice Questions. Each sub-part carries 1 mark. Choose the correct option.
4. Section B contains Question Nos. 2 to 5, which are very short answer questions carrying 2 marks each. Answer each question in at least 20 words.
5. Section C contains Question Nos. 6 and 7, which are short answer questions carrying 3 marks each. Answer each question in about 40–60 words.
6. Section D contains Question Nos. 8 and 9, which are long answer questions carrying 5 marks each. Answer each question in about 80–100 words.
7. Section E contains Question Nos. 10 to 13, which are source/case-based questions carrying 4 marks each (1+1+2). Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow.
8. Section F contains Question No. 14, a map-based question carrying 5 marks. Mark the given locations on the map using appropriate symbols/signs.
9. No overall choice has been provided in the question paper; however, internal choices are given in some questions. Attempt only one option in such questions.
10. For Visually Impaired students, a separate question has been provided in place of Question No. 14. It is to be attempted only by Visually Impaired students.
11. Maintain neatness and clarity while writing answers.

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) The largest desert on Earth, covering over 14 million square kilometres, is — **(1)**

(A) the Sahara (B) the Gobi (C) Antarctica (D) the Thar

(ii) In the Indian Parliament, a Bill that is not a Money Bill may be introduced in — **(1)**

(A) only the Lok Sabha (B) either House
(C) only the Rajya Sabha (D) only the Supreme Court

(iii) Gandhi gave the call 'Do or Die' during the — **(1)**

(A) Quit India Movement (B) Non-Cooperation Movement
(C) Dandi March (D) Khilafat Movement

(iv) Arrange the following events in chronological order and select the correct option. **(1)**

1. Jama Masjid, Delhi
2. Kailasha Temple, Ellora (8th century CE)
3. Victoria Memorial, Kolkata
4. Sanchi Stupa (Ashokan period)

(A) 4, 2, 1, 3 (B) 2, 4, 1, 3 (C) 4, 1, 2, 3 (D) 4, 2, 3, 1

(v) The Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2023 replaced the — **(1)**

(A) Indian Penal Code, 1860 (B) Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973
(C) Indian Evidence Act, 1872 (D) Constitution of India

(vi) Savitribai Phule opened a school for girls in 1848 in — **(1)**

(A) Kolkata (B) Madras (C) Pune (D) Surat

(vii) A population pyramid with a very wide base and a narrow top shows that the country has — **(1)**

(A) very few children and many elderly people
(B) equal numbers in all age groups
(C) no working-age people
(D) many children, a high birth rate and few elderly people

(viii) Fill in the blank with the appropriate option. **(1)**

The Master Plan of Singapore, which guides its growth, is updated every ..... years.

(A) 50 (B) 25 (C) 5 (D) 1

(ix) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option. **(1)**

Statement I: India has largely avoided the 'resource curse' by investing in industries that process its resources.
Statement II: Non-renewable resources regenerate within a few years.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

(x) The Khalsa was founded in 1699 by — **(1)**

(A) Guru Gobind Singh (B) Guru Nanak
(C) Guru Arjan Dev (D) Guru Tegh Bahadur

(xi) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option. **(1)**

Assertion (A): Shivaji's soldiers and officials served the state loyally.
Reason (R): Shivaji ended hereditary land assignments and paid his officials salaries from the treasury.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

(xii) The practice of sati was abolished in 1829 during the time of Governor-General — **(1)**

(A) Lord Dalhousie (B) Lord Cornwallis
(C) Lord Wellesley (D) William Bentinck

(xiii) The VVPAT machine used with EVMs allows a voter to — **(1)**

(A) vote from home on the internet
(B) see a slip showing the party symbol of the candidate voted for
(C) vote twice
(D) know the vote count

(xiv) In economics, the factor of production 'land' includes — **(1)**

(A) only farmland
(B) all natural resources such as soil, water, forests and minerals
(C) only buildings
(D) only money

(xv) Tansen, one of the nine ratnas of Akbar's court, was a renowned singer of the — **(1)**

(A) bhajan style only (B) folk ballad style
(C) ghazal style (D) dhrupad style

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) Name the four factors of production and the reward for each. **(2)**

OR

2.(B) Differentiate between a natural resource and a human-made resource, with one example each. **(2)**

3. What are jalis? State two purposes they serve. **(2)**

4.(A) What is the fertility rate? Why has it fallen in many places? **(2)**

OR

4.(B) What is urban planning? Why is it needed? **(2)**

5. Who was Razia Sultan? Why is she remembered? **(2)**

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Describe the formation and early aims of the Indian National Congress in 1885. **(3)**

OR

6.(B) Explain any three features of the Swadeshi Movement. **(3)**

7.(A) Explain in three steps how a Bill becomes a law in India. **(3)**

OR

7.(B) Write any three differences between the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha. **(3)**

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) What is discrimination? Explain how it affects individuals and society, and suggest three ways of preventing it. **(5)**

OR

8.(B) Describe the structure of the Indian judiciary with reference to the Supreme Court, High Courts and subordinate courts. **(5)**

9. Describe the electoral process in India from the announcement of elections to the declaration of results. **(5)**

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. **Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)**

> Yellowstone National Park in the Rocky Mountains had a problem: there were too many elk, a type of deer, and they grazed the plants so heavily that the landscape was damaged. In 1995, wolves, which hunt elk, were brought back to the park. The number of elk fell, the plants slowly returned, and many other animals came back to the restored habitat.

Questions:

(10.1) What was the ecological problem in Yellowstone? (1)

(10.2) Which animal was introduced in 1995 to restore the balance? (1)

(10.3) What lesson does this give about nature and human action? State two points. (2)

11. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In 1951–52, India held its first general elections, soon after becoming a republic. Most of the nearly 17 crore voters had never voted before and many could not read or write, so each party's symbol was placed on its own ballot box. Sukumar Sen, the first Chief Election Commissioner, organised the vast exercise over several months.

Questions:

(11.1) Who was the first Chief Election Commissioner of India? (1)

(11.2) Why were symbols used for parties on ballot boxes? (1)

(11.3) How did these elections reflect the principle of universal adult franchise? Give two points. (2)

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> The table gives the total fertility rate (TFR) and female literacy of two places.

Place	TFR (children per woman)	Female literacy (%)
Bihar	3.0	55
Delhi	1.6	83.7

Questions:

(12.1) Which place has the higher fertility rate? (1)

(12.2) By how many percentage points does Delhi's female literacy exceed Bihar's? (1)

(12.3) What relationship does the table suggest between female literacy and fertility? Name one measure to improve it. (2)

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In 1932, B.R. Ambedkar argued that the Depressed Classes needed separate electorates to ensure their political voice. Gandhi, then in Yerwada jail, feared that separate electorates would divide Hindu society and went on a fast. After discussion, Gandhi and Ambedkar agreed on the Poona Pact: separate electorates were given up, but more seats were reserved for the Depressed Classes in the general electorate.

Questions:

(13.1) Who demanded separate electorates for the Depressed Classes? (1)

(13.2) What was the outcome of the Poona Pact? (1)

(13.3) Why did Gandhi oppose separate electorates? Give one reason and one criticism that can be made of his fast. (2)

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5) **(5)**

(I) Kakori
(II) Jodhpur (Mehrangarh Fort)
(III) Madurai
(IV) Chennai
(V) Gurugram
(VI) Jaisalmer

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Kakori located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Jodhpur located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Madurai located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Chennai located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Gurugram located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Jaisalmer located? 1

